

**SYNTHETIC TRAINING RECORD — FICTIONAL PARTIES, PEOPLE,
OFFICES, IDENTIFIERS, AND EVENTS — NOT A REAL FILING OR
PRESENTENCE REPORT**

Certificate of Confidentiality and Sealed- Volume Protocol

United States Court of Appeals for the Fourth Circuit United States v. Mateo Serrano
Appeal No. SYN-CA4-26-CR-4201 Document 8 Filed April 1, 2026

Celia Arden certifies under Fourth Circuit Local Rule 25(c) that the materials identified here derive from presentence papers protected in district docket SYN-MDNC-25-CR-0328. The certificate accompanies Serrano's public motion filed today and applies only to the four appellate pairs listed below. It does not request protection for any other filing or legal proposition.

The lower authority consists of the then-effective Middle District of North Carolina rules that automatically protected the presentence report, sentencing-factor positions, responses, objections, and sentencing memoranda. The Judicial Conference policy excluding a presentence report from the public criminal file also supports a docket surrogate rather than public reproduction of that report.

Each proposed pair has equal logical pages and corresponding subjects. The public member retains the caption, legal questions, cited authorities, procedural facts, and requested relief. The protected member substitutes only synthetic confidential details needed for exercise review. The certificate discloses no real personal information and does not reproduce protected contents.

Brief-Pair Schedule

The opening pair consists of a sixteen-page public-redacted brief and a sixteen-page sealed-highlighted brief. Their fourth pages address the accepted waiver's scope in different language, and their ninth pages address the manager-or-supervisor dispute. The public version uses approved fictional category tokens where a protected detail would otherwise appear.

The government response pair consists of fourteen pages on each side. Both versions follow the same sequence from issue statement through certification, with the seventh page addressing the asserted possibility of a lower sentence. The appellant reply pair consists of eight pages each; its fifth pages address the agreement's express allocution reservation.

For all three brief pairs, a reader can follow the complete legal analysis from the public counterpart. Confidentiality does not hide the parties' positions on waiver enforceability, complete denial of allocution, plain-error review, prejudice, or remedy. The sealed member adds only inert synthetic labels and protected contextual material. Public and sealed prose is independently composed so correspondence does not become verbatim duplication.

Separate Presentence Volume

The fourth disclosure contains six public pages and six protected pages. Its public member is a docket surrogate and category index for the separate appellate presentence volume. It is not a redacted presentence report, does not summarize personal history, and cannot be used to reconstruct the protected member.

The surrogate's pages identify only boundary and index information, report-history categories, a stable volume-navigation subject, objection-packet categories, sentencing-submission categories, and certification. The protected twin uses inert fictional labels at matching offsets. The third page of each member supplies the corresponding stable volume subject without exposing a physical sealed-page reference to public consumers.

The sealed volume remains distinct from ordinary appendix materials. It may be served only through the protected exercise channel to authorized participants. Existing counsel access is not a basis for public availability, and the certificate does not claim that a real probation office or electronic court system permits the synthetic access method described here.

Access, Duration, and Certification

For a fictional workbench session, a sealed entry may appear only after a disclosure-specific grant tied to the exact resolved package. Every attempt to open that entry must newly verify its content-addressed location, declared size, digest, readable PDF form, and page total. The system must deny access after a missing file, link substitution, altered size, changed digest, unreadable object, or page mismatch.

A successful check exposes only a leased snapshot. Revocation closes the protected view, removes the sealed listing, and returns navigation to the public counterpart. Correction of a storage defect does not revive an old attempt; recovery requires another complete verification under a valid grant. These conditions describe a synthetic training application, not a PACER, CM/ECF, court, probation, or counsel account.

The requested protection continues only while the underlying confidentiality remains in force or until this court orders otherwise. Arden certifies that each public counterpart will be filed contemporaneously with its sealed twin, that every pair has the stated page equality, and that public notice remains adequate to evaluate the requested treatment.

Celia Arden Fictional Counsel for Mateo Serrano